Northwind Logistics Leave Policy 2024

Document owner: Elena Rossi, HR Director. This policy is effective from 1 January 2024 and supersedes Leave Policy 2021 (Version 2.4). It applies to all permanent employees.

1. Purpose and scope

1.1 This policy sets out the leave entitlements of permanent employees of Northwind Logistics B.V. and its subsidiaries in the Netherlands, Germany, Belgium, France, Italy, Poland and the United States.

1.2 Leave requests are made in the HR portal "Harbour" at harbour.northwind-logistics.example. Requests sent by email are not valid unless the portal is unavailable.

1.3 Part-time employees receive leave pro rata to their contracted hours. Local statutory minimums always prevail where they are higher than this policy.

2. Annual leave

2.1 Full-time employees are entitled to 24 working days of annual leave per calendar year. This entitlement is in addition to public holidays.

2.2 During the first 12 months of employment, leave accrues at 2 days per completed month. Leave accrued during probation may be taken only with the written agreement of the line manager.

2.3 Up to 5 unused days may be carried over and must be taken by 31 March of the following year. Days not taken by that date lapse without compensation.

2.4 Northwind observes 11 public holidays per year. The list is published each November by the Rotterdam HR team for the following calendar year.

2.5 Peak-season blackout

Between 1 and 24 December, leave is limited to 2 consecutive days per employee in operational roles at hubs and depots. Exceptions require approval from the Head of Operations, Lars Hendriksen.

3. Sick leave

3.1 Employees must inform their line manager before the start of their shift on the first day of absence.

3.2 A medical certificate is required for sick leave lasting more than 3 consecutive working days. The certificate must be uploaded to Harbour within 2 working days of issue.

3.3 Sick pay is 100% of base pay for the first 26 weeks of illness. After 26 weeks, local statutory sick pay rules apply.

4. Parental and family leave

4.1 Parental leave is 12 weeks at 80% of base pay. It may be taken within the first 12 months after the birth or adoption of a child.

4.2 Bereavement leave is 3 working days on the death of an immediate family member. Immediate family means spouse, partner, child, parent or sibling.

5. Other leave

5.1 Unpaid leave may be granted for up to 30 days in total per calendar year. Unpaid leave never counts towards annual leave accrual.

5.2 Employees who serve as volunteer firefighters or reservists are granted up to 5 additional working days per year for training.

6. Requesting and approving leave

6.1 Leave requests must be submitted at least 14 calendar days in advance. Shorter notice is accepted only for sick leave and bereavement leave.

6.2 Line managers may approve up to 10 consecutive days of leave; longer requests need Director approval.

6.3 Approvals are recorded in Harbour and confirmed to the employee by automatic email within 1 working day.